COVE

A LITTLE SPACE, TOGETHER

Make space for what matters.

A virtual companion supporting intentional study through small tasks, shared focus and reflective check-ins.



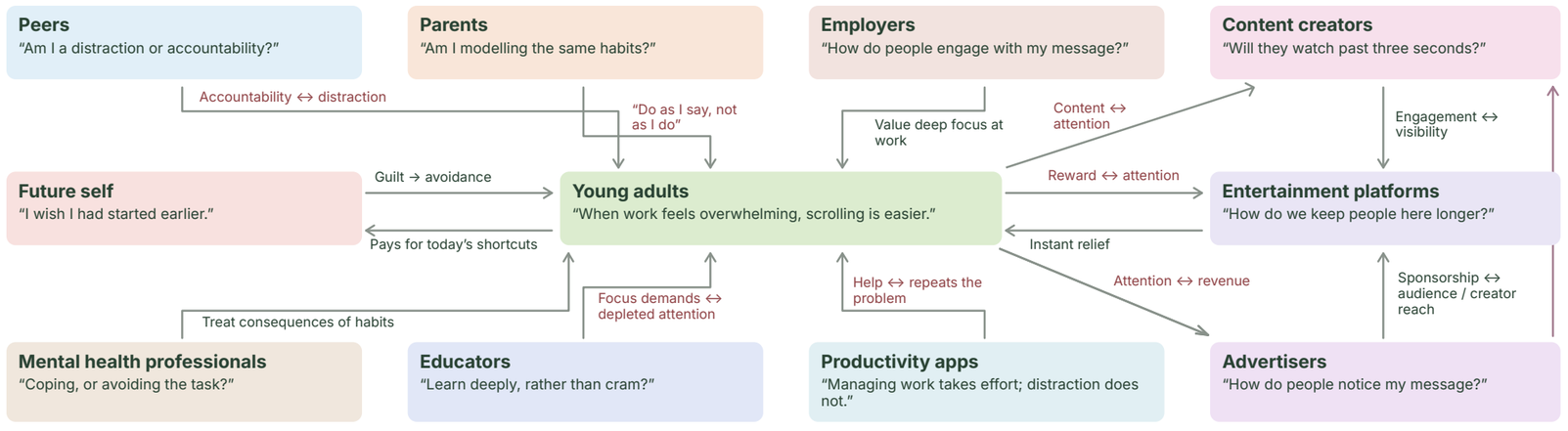
Domain

University students may turn to scrolling when study feels difficult, unclear or tiring. A short escape can delay both meaningful work and restorative rest.

DESIGN QUESTION

How might we make the next intentional choice easier?

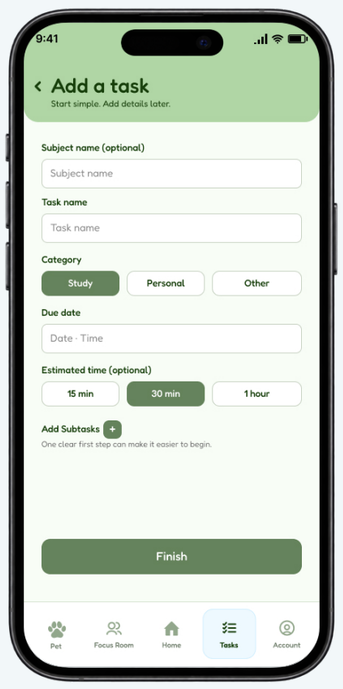
Rich Picture



Prototype

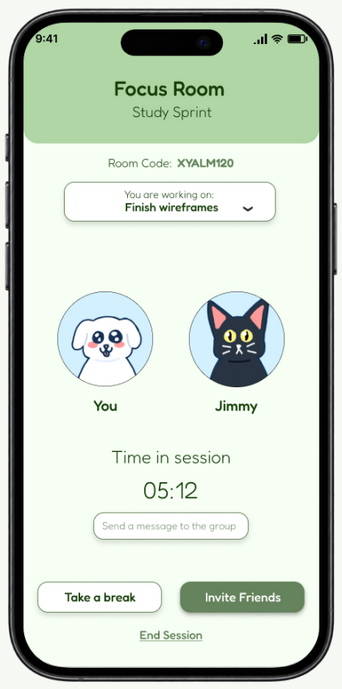
Six features supporting task initiation, focus and reflection.

Add a Task



Create a task with optional details and subtasks.

Focus Room



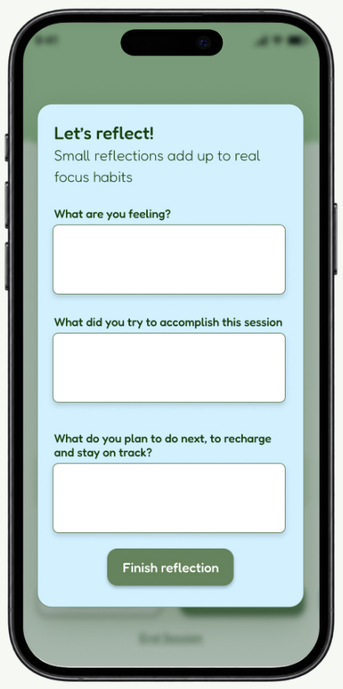
Work on a chosen task alongside a friend.

Pet Playground



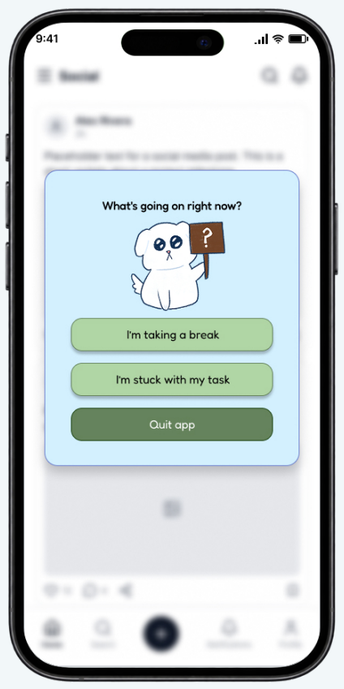
Visit your companion and personalise its space.

Reflection



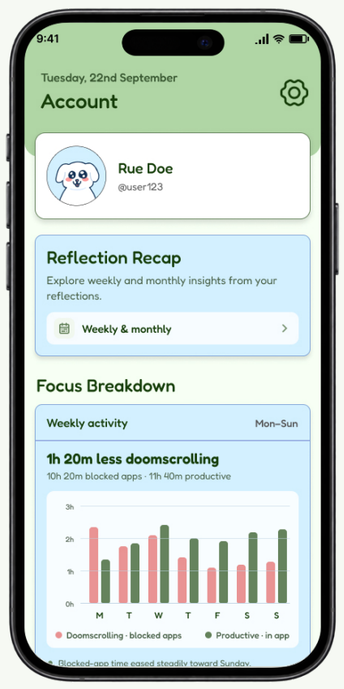
Reflect on the session and choose what to do next.

Lockout Check-in



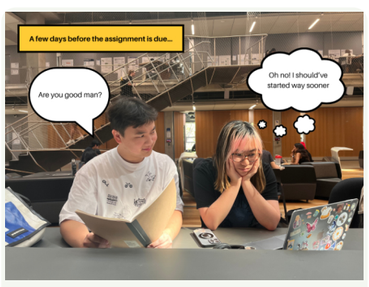
Pause scrolling for a break or support with your task.

Account Overview

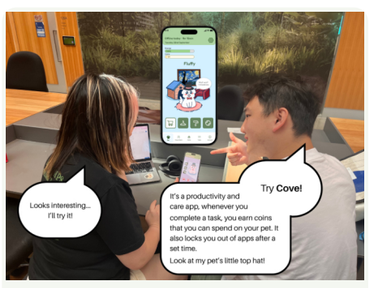


Access recaps and review weekly focus activity.

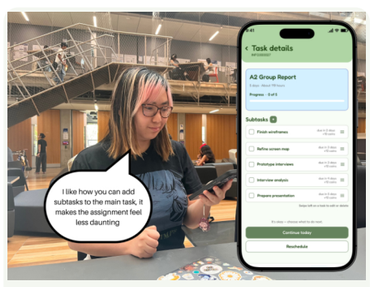
User Journey



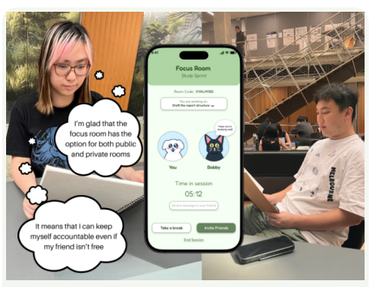
01 Deadline pressure



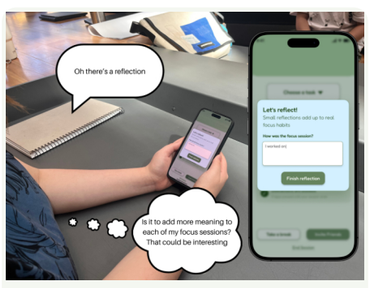
02 Discover Cove



03 Break down a task



04 Focus together



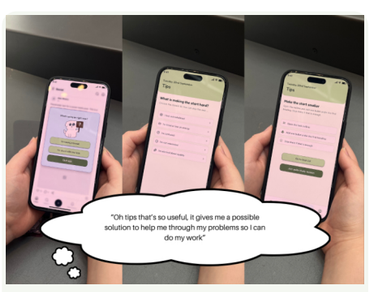
05 Reflect on the session



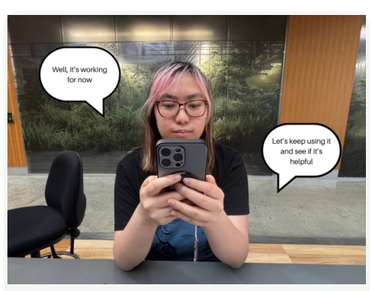
06 Notice the distraction



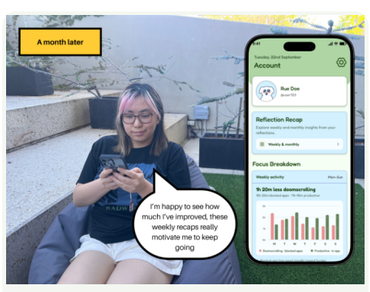
07 Check in



08 Choose a smaller step



09 Keep trying Cove



10 One month of using Cove



11 Proven Improvement

Evaluation

Usability testing task scenarios:

- Setup an account
- Task creation
- Starting a focus room
- Interact and customise pet
- Reflection from lock-out feature

9 **University students**
Aged 18-22 participated in scenario based-testing.

84.58 /100 Average SUS Score, indicating positive overall functionality.

Findings

Onboarding
Participants understood Cove's purpose, with opportunities to make key features easier to discover.

Task Management
Flexible task breakdowns supported different planning reference.

Focus Rooms
Options between studying independently and with friends suit different user preferences.

Lockout & Tips
Pop-up blocker were useful for interrupting distractions and returning to study.

Reflection & Analytics
Tracking progress via data-driven insights and written reflections informs personal growth.

Pet Playground
The virtual pet added a playful element, while participant differed in motivation to get incentives.

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